KEVIN C. K. MA, PhD

Postdoctoral Research Fellow[1,2]

[1] Department of Zoology, University of British Columbia
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[2] Hakai Institute, Sentinels of Change Alliance
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EDUCATION

2020	**PhD in Oceanography**, Université Laval
2012	**MSc in Biology**, Memorial University of Newfoundland
2008	**BSc in Biology: Ecology & Environmental Biology**, University of British Columbia

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Overview:

Research experience in marine and estuarine ecology, with extensive fieldwork in subtidal and intertidal systems, in aquatic environments ranging from subtropical to arctic

Proficient in scientific communication and engagement, including publishing in scholarly journals, presenting at conferences, organising workshops, and coordinating outreach activities

Multi-institutional partnerships with academic, government, and museum researchers, as well as stakeholder engagements with non-profits, industry, and Indigenous communities

Current postdoctoral research focused on investigating the patterns and processes of biodiversity in the rocky intertidal and how this system responds to the effects of climate change

My research interests: coastal biogeography, supply-side ecology, species interactions, biological invasions, biological diversity, and taxonomy of marine invertebrates

Research history:

2025 – Present **Postdoctoral Research Fellow** (Sentinels of Change Alliance), University of British Columbia
Presently carrying out a research program on the ecology of intertidal habitats to uncover patterns and processes shaping intertidal biodiversity, with particular a particular interest on understanding how this system responds to the effects of climate change. Academic advisors: Christopher D.G. HARLEY & Alyssa-Lois M. GEHMAN

2022 – 2024 **Postdoctoral Fellow** (Mitacs Accelerate), Memorial University of Newfoundland
Conducted applied and fundamental research on sea cucumbers focusing on anomalous morphological phenomena, disease, parasitism, excretion of metabolic wastes, population dynamics, and fisheries science. Gained experience with under-ice ROV surveys, laboratory management, and animal husbandry. Engaged in community outreach with Indigenous groups and supervised of undergraduate students. Academic advisor: Annie MERCIER

2019 – 2022 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow** (NRF Bursary), Rhodes University
Carried out research on the biogeography of marine invertebrates on rocky shores, focusing on range edge dynamics, range shifts, and species interactions. Reconstructed historical patterns of spread by invasive species. Investigated the relationship of endolithic infestation and epibiont load on mussels. Described a newly identified bryozoan species. Supervised undergraduate students. Academic advisors: Christopher D. MCQUAID & P. William FRONEMAN

2013 – 2019 **PhD Candidate** (NSERC CAISN II), Université Laval
Investigated the distribution and abundance of benthic invertebrates across multiple spatial and

temporal scales to optimise field sampling strategies for early detection of marine invasive species. Conducted field studies on the relationship between larval supply and settlement patterns. Academic advisors: Ladd E. JOHNSON & Christopher W. MCKINDSEY

2012 **Research Assistant** (NSERC CAISN II), Université du Québec à Rimouski
Assisted with field logistics and fieldwork for studies on the composition of biofouling assemblages and recruitment patterns under different climate scenarios. Contributed to the discovery of several marine invertebrate species invading the Canadian Maritimes. Principal investigators: Christopher W. MCKINDSEY & Claudio DIBACCO

2009 – 2012 **MSc Candidate** (NSERC Supplemental Strategic Grant), Memorial University of Newfoundland
Carried out research on the larval settlement patterns and population dynamics of an invasive ascidian. Developed best practices for the management and eradication of invasive ascidians. Performed a literature review on the diversity and distribution of native and non-native ascidians in eastern Canada. Academic advisors: Don DEIBEL & Cynthia H. MCKENZIE

2007 – 2008 **Undergraduate Research Assistant** (HRSDC & NSERC USRA), University of British Columbia
Assisted in identifying critical marine habitats through field-based interviews with resource users. Supported investigations into long-term ecological changes by collecting and processing historical and contemporary abundance data of marine invertebrates from published sources. Principal investigators: Kai M.A. CHAN & M. L. Deng PALOMARES

AWARDS, FUNDING, & FELLOWSHIPS (estimated value: 235,600 USD)

2025	Funding for Undergraduate Research Project, Micro-Experience Program, Biology Undergraduate Diversity in Research (BUDR), University of British Columbia	1,000 CAD
2025	Page Publication Grant (No. PP28/2025), Research Office, Rhodes University	840 EUR
2025 – Present	Postdoctoral Fellowship, Sentinels of Change Alliance	31,500 CAD
2024	Conference Travel Fund, Professional Development Fund for Postdoctoral Fellows, Memorial University of Newfoundland	800 CAD
2023	Conference Stipend, Early Career Ocean Professionals Canada	375 EUR
2023	Page Publication Grant (No. PP18/2023), Research Office, Rhodes University	3,500 USD
2023 – 2024	Accelerate Fellowship (No. 29594), Mitacs	100,000 CAD
2022	Accelerate Fellowship (No. 15224), Mitacs	15,000 CAD
2022	Research Grant, Research Committee, Rhodes University	15,000 ZAR
2021	Travel & Subsistence Grant (No. TSPD07/2021), Research Office, Rhodes University	30,000 ZAR
2021	Page Publication Grant (No. PP86/2021), Research Office, Rhodes University	840 EUR
2021	Page Publication Grant (No. PP69/2021), Research Office, Rhodes University	1,760 USD
2020	Archiving & Publication Bonus (*Prime à l'archivage et la publication*), Québec-Océan	500 CAD
2020	Research Bonus, South African Research Chairs Initiative: Marine Ecosystems and Resources, Rhodes University	20,000 ZAR
2019 – 2022	NRF Bursary, National Research Foundation	600,000 ZAR
2019	Bursary in Marine Ecology (*Bourse en écologie marine*), Université Laval	500 CAD
2019	Financial Assistance for Conferences (*Aide financière aux congrès*), Québec-Océan	1,000 CAD
2019	Individual Grant for a Conference (*Subvention individuelle pour un congrès*), Association des étudiant(e)s gradué(e)s en sciences et en génie, Université Laval	300 CAD
2019	Educational Grant (*Subvention pédagogique*), Association des étudiantes et des étudiants de Laval inscrits aux études supérieures, Université Laval	200 CAD
2018	Léon-Provancher Bursary (*Bourse Léon-Provancher*), Université Laval	500 CAD
2017	Dr. R.C. Frazee and Dr. W.B. Scott Student Research Award, Huntsman Marine Science Centre	2,500 CAD
2017	Financial Assistance for Short-term Training (*Aide financière pour formation courte*), Québec-Océan	1,500 CAD
2017	Fellowship, Smithsonian Tropical Research Institute	400 USD
2016	Financial Assistance for Conferences (*Aide financière aux congrès*), Québec-Océan	1,000 CAD
2016	Individual Grant for a Conference (*Subvention individuelle pour un congrès*), Association des étudiant(e)s gradué(e)s en sciences et en génie, Université Laval	200 CAD

2016	Travel Grant, North Pacific Marine Science Organization	800 CAD
2015	Travel Grant, Atlantic Canada Coastal and Estuarine Science Society	200 CAD
2015	Travel Bursary, NSERC Canadian Aquatic Invasive Species Network II (CAISN)	2,780 CAD
2015	Richard-Bernard Fund (*Fonds Richard-Bernard*), Université Laval	300 CAD
2013	Educational Grant (*Subvention pédagogique*), Association des étudiantes et des étudiants de Laval inscrits aux études supérieures, Université Laval	150 CAD
2013	Léon-Provancher Bursary (*Bourse Léon-Provancher*), Université Laval	300 CAD
2013 – 2016	PhD Stipend, NSERC Canadian Aquatic Invasive Species Network II (CAISN)	57,000 CAD
2013	Grant for a Conference (*Subvention congrès*), Association des chercheures et chercheurs-étudiant(e)s de biologie de l'Université Laval	75 CAD
2012	Student Bursary, Newfoundland Aquaculture Industry Association	300 CAD
2012	Graduate Student Travel Assistance, Memorial University of Newfoundland	2,100 CAD
2009 – 2011	MSc Stipend, NSERC Supplemental Strategic Grant	36,000 CAD
2008	Undergraduate Student Research Award (USRA), NSERC	4,500 CAD
2008	Poster Prize, Office of Vice President Research, University of British Columbia	100 CAD
2008	Student Initiatives Fund, Alma Mater Society, University of British Columbia	112 CAD
2007	Stipend, Summer Work Experience, Human Resources and Skills Development Canada (HRSDC)	4,320 CAD

DISTINCTIONS & PRIZES

2018	Best Talk, 9ème Colloque de département de biologie, Université Laval
2016	Highly Commended (talk), 9th International Conference on Marine BioInvasions
2015	Best Talk Runner-up, 6ème Colloque de département de biologie, Université Laval
2014	Best Poster Runner-up, Canadian Aquatic Invasive Species Network Annual General Meeting
2012	Fellow of the School of Graduate Studies, Memorial University of Newfoundland
2010	People's Choice Award (talk), 3rd Annual Biology Graduate Student Symposium, Memorial University of Newfoundland
2008	Best Poster, 7th Multidisciplinary Undergraduate Research Conference, University of British Columbia

PUBLICATIONS

Summary: 27 peer-reviewed publications (20 first-authored), 1 accepted, 1 submitted, 1 preprint, 2 in prep.
287 citations, h-index of 11 (Google Scholar as of October 2026)
ORCID: 0000-0003-1678-077X

Peer-reviewed publications: (IF = 2024 impact factor)

27.	**Ma KCK**, MacLeod CD, Janusson C, Ho J-A, Lemay MA, Gehman A-LM, Harley CDG. 2026. Genetic evidence for the microphallid trematode *Maritrema gratiosum* in the Northeast Pacific and an overview of its global distribution. *Journal of Helminthology* 100: e79. https://doi.org/10.1017/S0022149X26101771	0 citations IF: 2.0
26.	Pierrat J, **Ma KCK**, Hamel J-F, Mercier A. 2026. Spatial and size distributions of early recruits of *Cucumaria frondosa* in a coastal nursery (Nunavut, Canadian Arctic). *Regional Studies in Marine Science* 96: 104920. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.rsma.2026.104920	1 citation IF: 2.4
25.	**Ma KCK**, Gover LE, Hamel J-F, Mercier A. 2026. Optimizing the use of portable ROVs for community-based benthic surveys: A case study on the demographics of sea cucumbers around nursery habitats in the Arctic. *Polar Science* 47: 101287. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.polar.2025.101287	4 citations IF: 2.0
24.	**Ma KCK**, Hamel J-F, Mercier A. 2026. Proposed revision of 'crystal cells' as phagocytised metabolic by-products in holothuroid echinoderms. *Journal of the Marine Biological Association of the United Kingdom* 106: e9. https://doi.org/10.1017/S002531542510101X	3 citations IF: 0.9
23.	**Ma KCK**, Gao F, Hamel J-F, Mercier A. 2025. Diversity and distribution of	2 citations

extracellular microcrystals in holothuroid echinoderms. *Royal Society Open Science* 12: 250514. https://doi.org/10.1098/rsos.250514 IF: 2.9

22. Pratt CJ, Trott TJ, Bernier RY, Boerder K, Goodwin C, Barrell J, Grégoire B, Rawlings TA, Cronmiller E, **Ma KCK**, Sargent PS, McBride MC, DiBacco C, Hiltz C, Kingsbury S. 2025. The overlooked introduction of the encrusting bryozoan *Juxtacribrilina mutabilis* to eastern Canada. *Journal of the Marine Biological Association of the United Kingdom* 105: e98. https://doi.org/10.1017/S0025315425100362 — 3 citations, IF: 0.9

21. Corbisier G, **Ma KCK**, Jobson SM, Hamel J-F, Caulier G, Mercier A. 2025. Morphological variations and dysmorphic features in the sea cucumber *Cucumaria frondosa*. *Canadian Journal of Zoology* 103: 1–13. https://doi.org/10.1139/cjz-2025-0008 — 2 citations, IF: 1.1

20. **Ma KCK**, Reddy S, Froneman PW, Porri F, McQuaid CD. 2025. Locality-based community science facilitates early detection and monitoring: The case of an extralimital population of a brachyuran crab. *Management of Biological Invasions* 16 (2): 531–544. https://doi.org/10.3391/mbi.2025.16.2.12 — 1 citation, IF: 1.2

19. Zardi GI, **Ma KCK**, Froneman PW, Nicastro KR. 2025. First record of pyroplastic and partially burnt plastic litter along South African shores. *Marine Pollution Bulletin* 214: 117817. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.marpolbul.2025.117817 — 9 citations, IF: 4.9

18. Boonzaaier-Davids MK, **Ma KCK**, McQuaid CD. 2023. Epibiotic association of encrusting cheilostome bryozoans on shells of an invasive mussel from rocky shores of South Africa, with the description of a new aviculiferous species of *Chaperia*. *Zootaxa* 5258 (2): 197–210. https://doi.org/10.11646/zootaxa.5258.2.2 — 3 citations, IF: 0.9

17. **Ma KCK**, Monsinjon JR, Froneman PW, McQuaid CD. 2023. Thermal stress gradient causes increasingly negative effects towards the range limit of an invasive mussel. *Science of The Total Environment* 865: 161184. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2022.161184 — 11 citations, IF: 8.0

16. **Ma KCK**, Pulfrich A, Froneman PW, McQuaid CD. 2023. Invasion of rocky shores by a mytilid mussel reveals an abundant-centre distribution coupled with moderate increases in densities at its absolute range limits. *Austral Ecology* 48 (1): 197–214. https://doi.org/10.1111/aec.13260 — 0 citations, IF: 1.6

15. **Ma KCK**, McKindsey CW, Johnson LE. 2022. Detecting rare species with passive sampling tools: Optimizing the duration and frequency of sampling for benthic taxa. *Frontiers in Marine Science* 9: 809327. https://doi.org/10.3389/fmars.2022.809327 — 11 citations, IF: 3.0

14. **Ma KCK**, McQuaid CD. 2021. Review of range extensions of tropical brachyuran crabs into temperate waters of southern Africa. *Crustaceana* 94 (10): 1235–1262. https://doi.org/10.1163/15685403-bja10144 — 9 citations, IF: 0.7

13. **Ma KCK**, Redelinghuys S, Gusha MNC, Dyantyi SB, McQuaid CD, Porri F. 2021. Intertidal estimates of sea urchin abundance reveal congruence in spatial structure for a guild of consumers. *Ecology and Evolution* 11 (17): 11930–11944. http://doi.org/10.1002/ece3.7958 — 3 citations, IF: 2.3

12. **Ma KCK**, Gusha MNC, Zardi GI, Nicastro KR, Monsinjon JR, McQuaid CD. 2021. Biogeographic drivers of distribution and abundance in an alien ecosystem engineer: Transboundary range expansion, barriers to spread, and spatial structure. *Journal of Biogeography* 48 (8): 1941–1959. https://doi.org/10.1111/jbi.14124 — 13 citations, IF: 3.6

11. **Ma KCK**, McQuaid CD, Pulfrich A, Robinson TB. 2020. Status of a decennial marine invasion by the bisexual mussel *Semimytilus algosus* (Gould, 1850) in South Africa. *African Journal of Marine Science* 42 (4): 507–515. https://doi.org/10.2989/1814232X.2020.1820376 — 15 citations, IF: 1.4

10. **Ma KCK**, Zardi GI, McQuaid CD, Nicastro KR. 2020. Historical and contemporary range expansion of an invasive mussel, *Semimytilus algosus*, in Angola and Namibia despite data scarcity in an infrequently surveyed region. *PLoS ONE* 15 (9): e0239167. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0239167 — 15 citations, IF: 2.6

9. **Ma KCK**, McKindsey CW, Johnson LE. 2020. Larval supply is a limited determinant of settlement at mesoscales across an anthropogenic seascape. *Hydrobiologia* 847: 4015–4029. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10750-020-04391-y — 2 citations IF: 2.5

8. **Ma KCK**, Glon HE, Hawk HL, Chapman CN. 2020. Reconstructing the distribution of the non-native sea anemone, *Diadumene lineata* (Actiniaria), in the Canadian Maritimes: Local extinction in New Brunswick and no regional range expansion in Nova Scotia since its initial detection. *Regional Studies in Marine Science* 34: 101049. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.rsma.2020.101049 — 9 citations IF: 2.4

7. Carman MR, Colarusso PD, Neckles HA, Bologna P, Caines S, Davidson JDP, Evans NT, Fox SE, Grunden DW, Hoffman S, **Ma KCK**, Matheson K, McKenzie CH, Nelson EP, Plaisted H, Reddington E, Schott S, Wong MC. 2019. Biogeographical patterns of tunicates utilizing eelgrass as substrate in the western North Atlantic between 39º and 47º north latitude (New Jersey to Newfoundland). *Management of Biological Invasions* 10 (4): 602–616. https://doi.org/10.3391/mbi.2019.10.4.02 — 12 citations IF: 1.2

6. **Ma KCK**, Hawk HL, Goodwin C, Simard N. 2019. Morphological identification of two invading ascidians: New records of *Ascidiella aspersa* (Müller, 1776) from Nova Scotia and *Diplosoma listerianum* (Milne-Edwards, 1841) from New Brunswick and Quebec. *BioInvasions Records* 8 (1): 50–64. https://doi.org/10.3391/bir.2019.8.1.06 — 7 citations IF: 1.4

5. **Ma KCK**, Goodwin C, Cooper JA. 2018. Second record of *Diplosoma listerianum* (Milne-Edwards, 1841) five years after and 280 kilometres from the site of the first record in Nova Scotia. *BioInvasions Records* 7 (2): 159–163. https://doi.org/10.3391/bir.2018.7.2.07 — 8 citations IF: 1.4

4. **Ma KCK**, Deibel D, Lowen JB, McKenzie CH. 2017. Spatio-temporal dynamics of ascidian larval recruitment and colony abundance in a non-indigenous Newfoundland population. *Marine Ecology Progress Series* 585: 99–112. https://doi.org/10.3354/meps12437 — 11 citations IF: 2.1

3. **Ma KCK**, Deibel D, Law KKM, Aoki M, McKenzie CH, Palomares MLD. 2017. Richness and zoogeography of ascidians (Tunicata: Ascidiacea) in eastern Canada. *Canadian Journal of Zoology* 95 (1): 51–59. https://doi.org/10.1139/cjz-2016-0087 — 11 citations IF: 1.1

2. **Ma KCK**, Simard N, Stewart-Clark SE, Bernier RY, Nadeau M, Willis J. 2016. Early detection of the non-indigenous colonial ascidian *Diplosoma listerianum* in eastern Canada and its implications for monitoring. *Management of Biological Invasions* 7 (4): 365–374. https://doi.org/10.3391/mbi.2016.7.4.06 — 12 citations IF: 1.2

1. Moore AM, Vercaemer B, DiBacco C, Sephton D, **Ma KCK**. 2014. Invading Nova Scotia: First records of *Didemnum vexillum* Kott, 2002 and four more non-indigenous invertebrates in 2012 and 2013. *BioInvasions Records* 3 (4): 225–234. https://doi.org/10.3391/bir.2014.3.4.03 — 56 citations IF: 1.4

Forthcoming publications:

5. Corbisier G, Hamel J-F, **Ma KCK**, Caulier G, Mercier A. Geographic range extension and new host of the parasitic *Gonospora gonadipertha* (Djakonov, 1923) (Apicomplexa: Uropsoridae). Submitted to the *Canadian Field Naturalist*. — ACCEPTED

4. Loughnan D, Farrugia Drakard V, Holt CC, **Ma KCK**, Maher E, Ng CKH, Salland N, Blackwood P, Gehman, A-LM, Harley CDG, Hessing-Lewis M, Keeling P, Kellogg C, King K, Lemay M, Moore A, Martone P, O'Connor M, Parfrey L. Biodiversity science must include both microbial and macrobial diversity. Submitted to *Nature Reviews Biodiversity*. — SUBMITTED

3. Ng CKH, **Ma KCK**, Ho J-A, MacLeod CD, Gehman A-LM, Harley CDG. Parasitism of an intertidal foundation species: Allometric scaling and environmental constraints on trematode distribution in barnacles across biological scales. Preprint on *EcoEvoRxiv*. https://doi.org/10.32942/X2K680 — PREPRINT

2. **Ma KCK**, Hamel J-F, Mercier A. Geographic range extension of the dendrochirotid sea cucumber *Cucumaria parassimilis* in Newfoundland and Labrador, eastern — IN PREP.

Canada. Target journal: *Marine Biology Research.*

1. **Ma KCK**, Dievart AM, Bernier-Desmarais A, Gusha MNC, Rius M, Wyness AJ, Firth LB, Knights AM, Froneman PW, McQuaid CD. Diversity and distribution of intertidal rocky-shore invertebrates across five marine ecoregions in South Africa. Target journal: *Biological Diversity.* — IN PREP.

Other academic works: (papers in non-indexed scholarly journals, technical reports, and theses)

10. **Ma KCK**, Pierrat J, Hamel J-F, Mercier A. 2025. Unexpected biotic substrata utilised by newly-settled recruits of the sea cucumber *Cucumaria frondosa* in their nursery habitat. *SPC Beche-de-mer Information Bulletin* 45: 59–62. https://www.spc.int/digitallibrary/get/e6jqz — 5 citations

9. Pierrat J, Tucker A, **Ma KCK**, Hamel J-F, Mercier A. 2025. Association between a marine halacarid mite (Halacaroidea: Arthropoda) and early juveniles of the northern sea cucumber *Cucumaria frondosa* in Nunavut. *SPC Beche-de-mer Information Bulletin* 45: 56–58. https://www.spc.int/digitallibrary/get/zrezt — 2 citations

8. Scott MMF, **Ma KCK**, Wolvin S, Hamel J-F, Mercier A. 2024. First report of skin ulceration disease from temperate waters of the Northwest Atlantic: The case of the sea cucumber *Cucumaria frondosa*. *SPC Beche-de-mer Information Bulletin* 44: 22–26. https://www.spc.int/digitallibrary/get/u792s — 0 citations

7. Mercier A, Penney HD, **Ma KCK**, Lovatelli A, Hamel J-F. 2023. A guide to northern sea cucumbers: The biology and management of *Cucumaria frondosa*. *FAO Fisheries and Aquaculture Technical Paper*, No. 700. Rome, FAO, pp. xvii + 92. https://doi.org/10.4060/cc7928en — 13 citations

6. **Ma KCK**, Trenholm R, Hamel J-F, Mercier A. 2023. The enigma of stones found in the body cavities of sea cucumbers. *SPC Beche-de-mer Information Bulletin* 43: 32–38. https://www.spc.int/digitallibrary/get/23u6f — 0 citations

5. Samy SS, Froneman PW, McQuaid CD, **Ma KCK**. 2022. A review of decapod biological invasions of polar waters. *Biological Science: A Periodical of the Research of the Zoology and Entomology Honours Students* 1 (1): 69–74. — 0 citations

4. **Ma KCK**. 2020. *Rare species detection and benthic recruitment across multiple scales of space and time with implications for early detection of marine invasive species*. PhD Thesis, Université Laval, Québec, Québec, pp. xxiv + 238. http://hdl.handle.net/20.500.11794/38152 — 3 citations

3. Deibel D, McKenzie CH, Rise ML, Thompson RJ, Lowen JB, **Ma KCK**, Applin G, O'Donnell R, Wells T, Hall JR, Sargent P, Pilgrim BB. 2014. Recommendations for eradication and control of non-indigenous, colonial, ascidian tunicates in Newfoundland harbours. *Canadian Manuscript Report of Fisheries and Aquatic Sciences* 3039, pp. xi + 60. https://waves-vagues.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/Library/352814.pdf — 16 citations

2. **Ma KCK**. 2012. *Population dynamics of a non-indigenous colonial ascidian tunicate in a subarctic harbour*. MSc Thesis, Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John's, Newfoundland and Labrador, pp. xxii + 211. https://research.library.mun.ca/10937/ — 9 citations

1. **Ma KCK**, Deibel D, McKenzie CH. 2011. Indigenous and non-indigenous ascidian tunicates of Newfoundland and Labrador. *Proceedings of the Contributed Papers of the 27th Annual General Meeting of the Aquaculture Association of Canada*, Aquaculture Association of Canada Special Publication, No. 17: 58–63. https://aquacultureassociation.ca/wp-content/uploads/bsk-pdf-manager/2017/08/AC2010-Proceedings.pdf — 6 citations

INVITED TALKS & GUEST LECTURES

2025 Seminar Series of the Marine Institute Graduate Society, Fisheries and Marine Institute, St. John’s, Canada

2024 Seminar Series of the Department of Ocean Sciences, Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John’s, Canada

2024 Ocean Sciences Month, Johnson Geo Centre, St. John’s, Canada

2024 Sanikiluaq Hunters and Trappers Association, Sanikiluaq, Canada
2023 Champney's West Aquarium, Champney's West, Canada
2023 Sanikiluaq Hunters and Trappers Association, Sanikiluaq, Canada
2023 Sanikiluaq Community Fisheries Workshop, World Wildlife Fund Canada, Sanikiluaq, Canada
2022 Seminar Series of the Department of Zoology and Entomology, Rhodes University, Grahamstown, South Africa
2022 Stratford Hall, Vancouver, Canada
2021 STEM and Art Panel, School for Science and Math at Vanderbilt, Nashville, United States **webinar*
2020 Research and Career Seminar Series, School for Science and Math at Vanderbilt, Nashville, United States **webinar*
2017 Huntsman Marine Science Centre, St. Andrew's, Canada
2017 Bocas del Toro Research Station, Bocas del Toro, Panama
2017 Maurice Lamontagne Institute (*Institut Maurice-Lamontagne*), Mont-Joli, Canada
2012 4th Newfoundland and Labrador Aquatic Invasive Species Workshop, St. John's, Canada
2010 3rd Newfoundland and Labrador Aquatic Invasive Species Workshop, St. John's, Canada
2011 Newfoundland and Labrador Aquatic Invasive Species Advisory Committee, St. John's, Canada
2010 Newfoundland and Labrador Aquatic Invasive Species Advisory Committee, St. John's, Canada
2008 Peering into Research: Seminar Series, UBC Undergraduate Research Opportunities, Vancouver, Canada
2008 Science Week: Undergraduate Research Fair, UBC Science Undergraduate Society, Vancouver, Canada

COMMUNICATION & MEDIA COVERAGE

2026 UBC Today, "Breaking down research silos to understand a shifting Salish Sea" https://ubctoday.ubc.ca/breaking-down-research-silos
2021 Biogeography News, Journal of Biogeography, "ECR Feature: Kevin Ma on the abundance and distribution of invasive mussels" https://journalofbiogeographynews.org/2021/10/09/ecr-feature-kevin-ma-on-the-abundance-and-distribution-of-invasive-mussels/
2019 Québec-Océan, "Culture on full display adds value to scientific meetings" https://quebecocean.wordpress.com/2019/01/30/culture-on-full-display-adds-value-to-scientific-meetings/
2017 Québec-Océan, "Taxonomy is more important than ever" https://quebecocean.wordpress.com/2017/09/14/taxonomy-is-more-important-than-ever/
2014 CBC Information Morning Cape Breton, "Invasive species research" **radio interview*
2013 The Blue Heron, The Bras d'Or Stewardship Society, "Lake-wide non-native tunicate research program" (Volume 16, No. 11, pp. 6–7) https://brasdorstewardshipsociety.org/drupal/sites/default/files/July 2013.pdf
2012 The Cold Harvester, Newfoundland Aquaculture Industry Association, "A closer look at student research: Seasonal population dynamics of a non-indigenous ascidian tunicate in a subarctic harbour" (Winter Issue, pp. 29–29)
2011 The Cold Harvester, Newfoundland Aquaculture Industry Association, "Newfoundland's alien tunicates: An overview of a collaborative research program to understand and control the spread of the golden star tunicate and violet tunicate" (Spring Issue, pp. 22–24)
2011 Fisheries and Oceans Canada, "Aquatic Invasive Species: Golden star tunicate in Newfoundland and Labrador waters" https://waves-vagues.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/Library/365567.pdf **content creator*
2011 Fisheries and Oceans Canada, "Aquatic Invasive Species: Violet tunicate in Newfoundland and Labrador waters" https://waves-vagues.dfo-mpo.gc. ca/Library/365576.pdf **content creator*

CONTRIBUTED TALKS

Scientific meetings:

2026 UArctic Congress 2026, Tórshavn, Faroe Islands **presented by co-author*
2026 2026 Annual Conference of the Canadian Society for Ecology and Evolution, Toronto, Canada **presented by co-author*

2026 47th Annual Pacific Ecology and Evolution Conference, Bamfield, Canada (best poster second runner-up) **presented by co-author*

2026 Ocean Sciences Meeting 2026, Glasgow, Scotland

2025 2025 North American Echinoderm Conference, Juneau, United States **presented by co-author*

2025 14th International Temperate Reefs Symposium, Brest, France **presented by co-author*

2024 17th International Echinoderm Conference and 2nd International Hemichordate Meeting, Puerto de la Cruz, Spain **one talk and two posters*

2024 2024 Ecosystem Studies of the Subarctic and Arctic Seas Annual Science Meeting, St. John's, Canada **one talk and one poster*

2023 11th European Conference on Echinoderms, Lyon France **one talk and one poster*

2023 56th European Marine Biology Symposium, Reykjavik, Iceland **presented by co-author*

2023 Canadian Meteorological and Oceanographic Society 57th Congress, St. John's, Canada

2022 12th Western Indian Ocean Marine Science Association Scientific Symposium, Port Elizabeth, South Africa **presented by student co-author*

2022 10th Biennial Conference of the International Biogeography Society, Vancouver, Canada

2019 12th International Temperate Reefs Symposium, Hong Kong, China

2016 17th Biennial Benthic Workshop, St. Andrew's, Canada

2016 45th Annual Benthic Ecology Meeting, Portland, United States

2016 9th International Conference on Marine BioInvasions, Sydney, Australia (highly commended)

2015 Atlantic Canada Coastal and Estuarine Science Society 2015 Conference, St. Andrew's, Canada

2015 44th Annual Benthic Ecology Meeting, Quebec City, Canada

2013 8th International Conference on Marine BioInvasions, Vancouver, Canada **presented by co-author*

2013 42nd Annual Benthic Ecology Meeting, Savannah, United States

2013 2013 Aquatic Sciences Meeting, New Orleans, United States **presented by co-author*

2012 2012 Ocean Sciences Meeting, Salt Lake City, United States

2011 6th International Tunicate Meeting, Montreal, Canada

2011 7th International Conference on Marine BioInvasions, Barcelona, Spain **presented by co-author*

2009 30th Annual Pacific Ecology and Evolution Conference, Bamfield, Canada

2008 Coastal Zone Canada 2008 Conference, Vancouver, Canada

Network and local meetings:

2026 Reimagining the Future of Oceans and Fisheries, Institute of the Oceans and Fisheries' 10 Year Anniversary Symposium, Vancouver, Canada

2025 1st Annual Ocean Sciences Conference, Ocean Sciences Student Graduate Association, St. John's, Canada **presented by co-author*

2025 4th Annual Invasive Species Forum, Nova Scotia Invasive Species Council, Halifax, Canada **presented by co-author*

2024 3rd Annual Scientific Endeavours in Academia Conference, Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John's, Canada (best poster) **presented by student co-author*

2019 10ème Colloque du département de biologie, Université Laval, Quebec City, Canada

2018 9ème Colloque du département de biologie, Université Laval, Quebec City, Canada (best talk)

2017 8ème Colloque du département de biologie, Université Laval, Quebec City, Canada

2016 15ème Assemblée Générale Annuelle, Québec-Océan, Rimouski, Canada

2016 Canadian Aquatic Invasive Species Network Annual General Meeting, Windsor, Canada

2016 7ème Colloque du département de biologie, Université Laval, Quebec City, Canada

2015 14ème Assemblée Générale Annuelle, Québec-Océan, Quebec City, Canada

2015 Canadian Aquatic Invasive Species Network Annual General Meeting, Halifax, Canada

2015 6ème Colloque du département de biologie, Université Laval, Quebec City, Canada (best talk runner-up)

2014 13ème Assemblée Générale Annuelle, Québec-Océan, Rivière-du-Loup, Canada

2014 Canadian Aquatic Invasive Species Network Annual General Meeting, Gatineau, Canada (best poster runner-up)

2014 5ème Colloque du département de biologie, Université Laval, Quebec City, Canada

2013 12ème Assemblée Générale Annuelle, Québec-Océan, Rivière-du-Loup, Canada

2013 Canadian Aquatic Invasive Species Network Annual General Meeting, Kananaskis, Canada

2012 Cold Harvest 2012, Gander, Canada

2011 Cold Harvest 2011, Gander, Canada
2011 4th Annual Biology Graduate Student Symposium, Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John's, Canada
2010 Aquaculture Canada 2010 and Cold Harvest 2010, St. John's, Canada
2010 3rd Annual Biology Graduate Student Symposium, Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John's, Canada (people's choice)
2010 Aldrich Interdisciplinary Conference, Graduate Students' Union, Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John's, Canada
2008 7th Multidisciplinary Undergraduate Research Conference, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada (best poster)

SUPERVISION & TEACHING

Supervision of honours and directed studies students:

2026 Nalan GOOSEN, Honours in Environmental Science, University of British Columbia **co-supervised*
2025 Nehal BHUSHAN, Direct Studies (BIOL 448), University of British Columbia **co-supervised*
2025 Joanne J.-A. HO, Direct Studies (BIOL 448), University of British Columbia **co-supervised*
2023 – 2024 Lauren E. GOVER, Honours in Biology, Memorial University of Newfoundland **co-supervised*
2022 Sheyenne S. SAMY, Honours in Zoology, Rhodes University **co-supervised*
2021 Emma L. GOODES, Honours in Marine Biology, Rhodes University **co-supervised*
2020 Alicea LUBBÉ, Honours in Marine Biology, Rhodes University **co-supervised*

Supervision of hired research assistants:

2025 – Present University of British Columbia: Ada BREKER (40 hr)
2022 – 2024 Memorial University of Newfoundland: Uswa AHMAD (40 hr), Alex L. T. DAY (40 hr), Bridget N. DUFF (40 hr), Anuj JYOTHYKUMAR (40 hr), Andrea J. LEYTE (390 hr), Kera R. WHITTEN (80 hr)
2022 Rhodes University: Amy BERNIER-DESMARAIS (160 hr), Rochelle BESSINGER (40 hr), Emma L. GOODES (40 hr), Molline N. C. GUSHA (80 hr), Lulutho MANCUNGA (160 hr), Sonwabise MANELI (80 hr), Siyamthanda MATIWANE (40 hr)
2013 – 2015 Université Laval: Émie AUDET-GILBERT (40 hr), Emma CARROLL (160 hr), E. Laurence FORGET-LACOURSIÈRE (480 hr), Jean-Marc JOUVE (480 hr), Caroline POTVIN (480 hr), Stéphanie ROY (40 hr)
2011 Memorial University of Newfoundland: Laura CHOMYSHYN (480 hr)

Mentorship and supervision of volunteers:

2025 – Present University of British Columbia: Sara BELLMAN (7 hr), Nehal BHUSHAN (22 hr), Kayla FOUDY (10 hr), Lila GEHRING (4 hr), Joanne J.-A. HO (75 hr), Cole IRELAND (3 hr), Danielle KIM (27 hr), Melissa KIM (5 hr), Cassidy Y. C. LEE (58 hr), Libby LEE (22 hr), Monica LIN (45 hr), Kaitlyn LIU (8 hr), Alicia TAO (10 hr), Jacqueline TINGLE (9 hr), Peach TRIPPELL (18 hr), Matthew VASQUEZ (5 hr), Anika WIJESURIYA (13 hr), Lisa Y. ZHANG (47 hr), Amy ZHOU (4 hr)
2023 – 2024 Memorial University of Newfoundland: Melanie E. COLLIER (80 hr), Emerald R. LAKE (20 hr), Megan M. F. SCOTT (80 hr)

Teaching:

2018 Teaching Assistant, Biodiversity of Invertebrates (BIOL 1011), Université Laval
2012 Teaching Assistant, Principles of Biology (BIOL 1002), Memorial University of Newfoundland
2011 Teaching Assistant, Biology of Invertebrates (BIOL 2122), Memorial University of Newfoundland
2011 Teaching Assistant, Ecology (BIOL 2600), Memorial University of Newfoundland
2011 Teaching Assistant, Evolution & Systematics (BIOL 2900), Memorial University of Newfoundland
2010 Teaching Assistant, Principles of Biology (BIOL 1001), Memorial University of Newfoundland

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Editorial boards:

2026 – Present Thematic Deputy Editor-in-Chief, *BioInvasions Records:* 5 assignments completed, 3 in progress
2022 – Present Thematic Editor, World Register of Introduced Marine Species (WRiMS)
2019 – Present Associate Editor, *Aquatic Invasions:* 6 assignments completed
2019 – Present Associate Editor, *Management of Biological Invasions:* 4 assignments completed
2019 – 2025 Associate Editor, *BioInvasions Records:* 10 assignments completed

Peer-reviews: (27 completed reviews of 24 manuscripts)

2025 *Bothalia: African Biodiversity & Conservation*; *Communications Earth & Environment*; *Journal of Applied Ecology*; *Scientific Data*
2024 *BioInvasions Records*; *PeerJ Life and Environment*; *Zoologischer Anzeiger*
2023 *Aquatic Invasions*; *BioInvasions Records* (2 reviews); *Journal of Ecology*; *PLoS One*
2022 *Estuarine, Coastal and Shelf Science*; *Journal of Experimental Marine Biology and Ecology*; *PLoS One*
2021 *Aquatic Invasions*; *Journal of Experimental Marine Biology and Ecology*; *Marine Biology*; *Marine Environmental Research*
2020 *BioInvasions Records*; *Invertebrate Systematics* (2 reviews); *Marine Pollution Bulletin*
2019 *Marine Ecology Progress Series* (2 reviews)
2018 *BioInvasions Records*; *Thalassas: An International Journal of Marine Science*

Service and leadership:

2026 Thesis Examiner (nominee) for a thesis submitted for a Bachelor of Science in Biology (Honours), University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
2026 Thesis Examiner (external) for a thesis submitted for a Master of Science in Zoology, Stellenbosch University, Stellenbosch, South Africa
2025 Volunteer, Imagine UBC, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
2025 Science Interpreter in marine biodiversity, Bella Bella Community School, Calvert Island, Canada
2025 Science Interpreter in marine biodiversity, Collingwood School, Morven Campus, West Vancouver, Canada
2025 Mentor to undergraduate students, Biology Undergraduate Diversity in Research (BUDR), Department of Zoology, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
2025 Panelist, Biological Diversity and Conservation (FRST 495), University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
2025 Interviewer, Research Involvement Fair, Undergraduate Research Opportunities (URO), University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
2024 – Present Committee Member, Steering Committee of the World Register of Introduced Marine Species
2024 Session Moderator and Judge, 3rd Annual Scientific Endeavours in Academia Conference, Faculty of Science, Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John's, Canada
2023 – 2024 Science Interpreter in marine biology, Paatsaali High School, Sanikiluaq, Canada
2023 Invited Reviewer, Alien Species Risk Analysis Review Panel (ASRARP) Risk Analysis of *Semimytilus patagonicus*, South African National Biodiversity Institute, Pretoria, South Africa
2023 Judge, 2nd Annual Scientific Endeavours in Academia Conference, Faculty of Science, Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John's, Canada
2023 Judge, Eastern Newfoundland Regional Science Fair, St. John's, Canada
2023 Invited Reviewer, Canadian Science Advisory Secretariat (CSAS) Regional Peer Review Meeting, Assessment of NAFO 3Ps Sea Cucumber, Fisheries and Oceans Canada, St. John's, Canada
2023 Organiser, Sea Cucumber Fishery Knowledge Transfer Workshop, Sanikiluaq Hunters and Trappers Association, Sanikiluaq, Canada
2022 – 2024 Committee Member, Echinoderm Expert Committee, Canadian BioGenome Project (https://earthbiogenome.ca/species.mhtml), Vancouver, Canada
2021 Judge, Eskom Expo for Young Scientists, South Africa
2019 Co-developer, Invasion Ecology (GCIE 500), Universidad Austral de Chile **remote work*
2018 Co-organiser, 4th World Conference on Marine Biodiversity, Montreal, Canada
2017 Volunteer, Arctic Change 2017, Quebec City, Canada
2017 Organiser, Ascidian Taxonomy Workshop, Atlantic Reference Centre, St. Andrew's, Canada
2017 Student Researcher, Canada C3 Science Program

2015 Co-organiser, Aquatic Invasive Species Knowledge Transfer Workshop, NSERC Canadian Aquatic Invasive Species Network II, Iqaluit, Canada
2015 Co-organiser, 44th Annual Benthic Ecology Meeting, Quebec City, Canada
2012 Judge, Science Fair, Killarney Secondary School, Vancouver, Canada
2011 Judge, Eastern Newfoundland Regional Science Fair, St. John's, Canada
2009 Volunteer, Pacific North Coast Integrated Management Area Forum, Richmond, Canada
2007 – 2008 Mentor to first-year undergraduate students, Tri-mentoring Program, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
2007 Volunteer, South Okanagan National Park Reserve Network, Penticton, Canada

In-kind research assistance: (taxonomic assistance and short-term field assistance)

2026 Intertidal brachiopod collections; Ekaterina KABANOVA, University of British Columbia
2025 Ascidian identifications; Cathleen DEELIE, University of Namibia
2025 Intertidal dogwhelk collections and sea star surveys; Christopher D.G. HARLEY, University of British Columbia
2025 Field manipulations on rocky shores, Seojeong PARK, University of British Columbia
2024 Ascidian identifications; Sophie WOLVIN, Memorial University of Newfoundland
2024 Environmental DNA collections; Andrew TUCKER, Memorial University of Newfoundland
2024 Ascidian identifications; Joseph MARLOW, Scottish Association for Marine Science
2023 Sea cucumber, mussel, and water sample collections; Méliane DESHAIES, Yuthika JALIM, and Andrea J. LEYTE, Memorial University of Newfoundland
2023 Ascidian identifications; William R. DRIEDZIC, Memorial University of Newfoundland
2022 Intertidal invertebrate collections; Melissa BOONZAAIER-DAVIDS, Iziko Museum
2022 Intertidal mussel collections; Lorenzo COZZOLINO, Universidade do Algarve
2020 Intertidal mollusc collections; Adam J. WYNESS, Rhodes University
2019 – 2020 Intertidal mussel collections and field manipulations on rocky shores; Cassandra BARKER and Mauricio OROSTICA VEGA, Rhodes University
2019 Seaweed collections; Molline N.C. GUSHA, Rhodes University
2019 Field manipulations on rocky shores and in marinas; Seshnee REDDY, South African Institute for Aquatic Biodiversity
2018 Seaweed collections; Manon PICARD, Simon Fraser University
2017 & 2022 Ascidian identifications; Claire GOODWIN, Atlantic Reference Centre
2017 Ascidian collections; Rosana M. da ROCHA, Universidade Federal do Paraná
2016 Seaweed collections; Ladd E. JOHNSON, Université Laval
2013 Field manipulations in marinas; Heather L. HAWK, Université Laval
2012 – 2015 Field manipulations in rivers; Nathan HAAG and Filippo FERRARIO, Université Laval
2012 Oceanographic data collections; Brian LEUNG, McGill University
2007 Deer mice collections; Jack TENG, University of British Columbia
2006 Field manipulations in eelgrass beds; Ramona C. de GRAAF, University of British Columbia

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE (non-academic and non-teaching positions)

2017 – 2019 Proctor (part-time), Département de biologie, Université Laval
2011 – 2012 Waste Audit Co-ordinator (part-time), Sustainability Office, Memorial University of Newfoundland
2009 Administrative Assistant (full-time), Northwest Wildlife Preservation Society
2008 – 2009 Intern (part-time), Ocean Wise and River Works, Vancouver Aquarium

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

2026 Centre for the Integration of Research, Teach and Learning (CIRTL) Associate, UBC Centre for Teaching, Learning and Technology
2026 Instructional Skills Workshop, UBC Centre for Teaching, Learning and Technology
2025 Marine Basic and Standard First Aid
2024 Wilderness and Remote First Aid
2023 Workplace Violence Prevention for Supervisors, Memorial University of Newfoundland

2022	Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System (WHMIS)
2022	Laboratory Safety Course, Memorial University of Newfoundland
2021	Strengthening Postgraduate Supervision, Rhodes University
2021	Environmental variables: How to obtain and process them with R, Transmitting Science
2021	Obtaining and cleaning species occurrence data with R, Transmitting Science
2018	Mapping in R: Basic and Advance Tools Workshop, Québec-Océan
2017	Taxonomy and Biology of Tunicate Course, Smithsonian Tropical Research Institute
2017	Information Security Awareness Training (ITS100), Smithsonian Institution
2017	DAN Emergency Oxygen Provider for Scuba Diving Injuries
2016	PADI Open Water Diver
2014	DAN Basic Life Support: CPR and First Aid
2013	Small Vessel Operator Proficiency (SVOP), Canadian Coast Guard
2013	Small Non-pleasure Vessel Basic Safety, Canadian Coast Guard
2013	Theoretical and Practical Trailer Towing Training

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

2024 – Present	Active Member, Canadian Association of Postdoctoral Scholars (No. 201901793)
2019 – Present	Associate Member, International Association for Open Knowledge on Invasive Alien Species
2013 – 2019	Student Member, Québec-Océan
2012 – 2015	Highly Qualified Personnel (HQP), NSERC Canadian Aquatic Invasive Species Network II

CURRENT & PAST POSTDOCTORAL ADVISORS

Christopher D.G. HARLEY, Professor, Department of Zoology, University of British Columbia Vancouver, Canada; harley@zoology.ubc.ca

Alyssa-Lois M. GEHMAN, Research Scientist, Hakai Institute, and Adjunct Professor, Institute of Oceans and Fisheries, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada; alyssa.gehman@hakai.org

Annie MERCIER, Professor, Department of Ocean Sciences, Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John's, Newfoundland and Labrador, Canada; amercier@mun.ca

P. William FRONEMAN, Professor, Department of Zoology and Entomology, Rhodes University, Grahamstown, Eastern Cape, South Africa; w.froneman@ru.ac.za

Christopher D. MCQUAID, Distinguished Professor, Department of Zoology and Entomology, Rhodes University, Grahamstown, Eastern Cape, South Africa; c.mcquaid@ru.ac.za